Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Country Specific Requirements Finland

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Applicability

Bayer Level:	CH, PH

This document is electronically approved (signatures on the last page)

Distribution Sheet for Quality Regulations

Division/Business Unit ☒ PH ☒ CH

GBS Location
☐ Global Business Services Barcelona
☐ Global Business Services Costa Rica/Brazil
☐ Global Business Services Manila
☒ Global Business Services Gdansk
☐ Global Business Services India
☐ Global Business Services Dalian
☐ Global Business Services Germany

Region/ Country
☐ Global
☒ Specific Country: Finland

Relevance for R&D QMS
☐ Affected
☐ Interface
☒ N/A

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Document Author(s):	Dominika Bizewska (EJKSR)
Document Approver(s):	GBS QA : Zaneta Gorska-Bilas (GMFRA) PTC Team Leader/ SME: Katarzyna Mazur-Kominek (GLISG) CQH : Katariina Alanne (SGYZF)
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Relevant Process and Activities:	PTC

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1 Scope and Framework

1.1 Scope

Bayer Country Quality Units are accountable for a GMP compliant Product Technical Complaint Management within their respective countries. Within this responsibility they are supported by the respective Global Business Service in process steps like complaint initiation, classification forwarding for investigation to the RQU, and final approval including complaint sample management and reimbursement process.

This SOP defines clear guidance to the Global Business Service regarding all country specific requirements.

1.2 Framework

This SOP is based on principles and requirements outlined in SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

2 Abbreviations

AE	Adverse Event
CMO	Contract Manufacturing Organization
CQH	Country Quality Head
CQU	Country Quality Unit
GBS	Global Business Service
OTC products	Over-the-counter products
PTC	Product Technical Complaint
PV	Pharmacovigilance
RQU	Responsible Quality Unit

3 Purpose & Set-Up

3.1 Purpose

Country Specific Requirements for Finland are described in this SOP, regarding e.g. Data Privacy, Sample Handling Process, Reimbursement Process, Contacts, escalation rules.

During the processing of all PTCs by Bayer owned Global Business Service all country specific requirements are considered and followed besides the general complaint handling described in the SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

3.2 General guidance

The employees of Global Business Services follow the SOP during complaint processing in the complaint database on behalf of the Country Quality Units.

3.3 Roles and responsibilities

GBS team	- Enters PTCs, Suspected Counterfeit Incidents and Usability Issues according to defined timelines in a timely manner, entering them into the global complaint database in English language - Organizes missing information and asks CQU for any support contacting the complainant if not possible/allowed by GBS (e.g. data privacy, non-hosted language) - Performs the initial intake of complaints after receipt - Informs the CQU about all PTCs where local authorities are involved, about all potential counterfeits and any other cases described in this SOP - Informs the respective PV about all PTCs with a potential associated AE or LODE or potentially reportable medical device complaints, including the unique complaint database number and all relevant follow-up information - Forwards the case to the respective RQU for further assessment - Initiates the process of sample shipment if requested by RQU or specified in any other guidance document - Reviews the case for plausibility and closes the complaint case in complaint database - Sends out standard response letters in case it is agreed with the CQU - Supports the process for reimbursement management - Forwards all cases that are not PTCs back to the CQU or to the appropriate function for further processing
Country Quality Head (CQH) / Country Quality Unit (CQU)	- Is responsible for regular KPI evaluation to get overview of complaint activities at the GBS - Supports the GBS in organizing missing complaint information - Organizes the complaint sample - Sends out the Response Letters to the complainants as requested and agreed with the GBS - Ensures that all changes within the country law and regulation are directly notified to the GBS and that the Country Specific SOP is updated

4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling

4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

4.1.1 General Information

In Finland the Bayer company operates under legal entities described as below:
Bayer Oy

The Headquarters is located in:
Espoo:
Bayer Oy
Tuulikuja 2
PO Box 73
FI-02151 Espoo
Global manufacturing site for all IUS products located in Finland:
Turku:
Bayer Oy
Pansiontie 47
20210 Turku
Finland

Remark:
Most of the complaints are received and managed in Tuovi internet system, which is used by all the pharmacies in Finland.

4.1.2 Contact list

Finland receives complaints to generic email address: *ptc.fi@bayer.com*

Country Quality Head:
Katariina Alanne (mainly PH products)
email address: *katariina.alanne@bayer.com*

CQH deputy:
Mervi Tuhkasaari (mainly CH products)
email address: *mervi.tuhkasaari@bayer.com*

Remark:
Current name and e-mail address of CQH and CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint:
https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.3 Escalation Rules The CQH and the CQH deputy should be notified via notification/immediate action in the complaint database about any complaint case referring to at least one of the following situations: - Suspected Counterfeit Cases - Any cases involving Health Authorities - Cases with final risk category high or medium (escalation via immediate action) **Remark:** The current names and e-mail addresses of the CQH and the CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list*	GBS
4.1.4 Pharmacovigilance cases If a complaint case is related to any type of Adverse Event, the Pharmacovigilance department has to be informed via the following e-mail address. *pv.nordics@bayer.com* unless this is the PV who sends information about PTC +AE to the GBS.	GBS
4.1.5 Product Samples Whenever a sample is requested for investigation, it needs to be returned to the pharmacy. **Complaints received via Tuovi system:** Sample shipment is outsourced to Tamro wholesaler. Tamro wholesaler sends samples once a week to the RQUs. After registering the case in the complaint database, GBS PTC officer adds the respective complaint ID to Tuovi chat. After the shipment, Tamro employee adds the shipping waybill number to Tuovi chat. Then GBS updates the case in the complaint database with shipping information. For special cases (urgent, when required by the RQU) GBS Officer can ask Tamro for photographic evidence or for the destruction of the sample. **Complaints received from different sources (Medical Information, private clinic, customers):** In case the sample is deemed necessary by GBS or required for investigation, GBS PTC Officer starts the process of obtaining sample by sending standard template (Annex 2.2) containing a request for a sample. The complainant is asked to return the product sample for the investigation through the pharmacy. Then GBS receives notification that complaint was registered via Tuovi system and sample retrieval starts as described above.	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
Essure cases: Essure samples are sent by the hospital or physician directly to Espoo office, to Business Support Specialist Riikka Aarnio(email address: riikka.aarnio@bayer.com. She sends an email to GBS PTC officers that includes sample information and a questionnaire from the physician for the respective PTC+AE. The GBS PTC officers send back the complaint ID of the entered complaint as the response to assistant's email and the sample can be shipped via DHL to Heredia, Costa Rica. **Radiology Samples:** If requested by regional manager or RQU, the medical device sample is shipped to manufacturing site or lead investigation site. **Essex Plus cases:** Phoenix Labs is responsible for the sample retrieval and shipment (see section 4.1.6. Exceptions and special cases).	
4.1.6 Statement letter	GBS
Acknowledgement Letter when a complaint comes in via Tuovi: After a complaint is handed in, GBS PTC Officer is entitled to acknowledge the case by adding the text attached in Annex 2.1. **Acknowledgement Letter when a complaint comes in from different sources (Medical Information, private clinic, customer):** After a complaint is handed in, GBS PTC Officer is entitled to acknowledge the case by sending the standard template in Annex 2.2. **Response Letter after closing:** Standard response letters are sent out without involvement of the CQU. In Finland, response letters need to be provided only when requested by the complainant. Depending on the source from which the complaint comes in, GBS PTC Officer adds the response attached in Annex 3 in Tuovi system or is sending it via e-mail. **Radiology Response Letter:** The requested response letter for radiology complaints is drafted by the RQU. **Exception:** The response letters to below mentioned exceptions are prepared by CQU. # Final Risk Classification High and Medium # In case of PTC + AE: involvement of PV # Authority responses **Remarks:** In case of complaints concerning handling issue of Bepanthen EDROS bottle, GBS PTC Officer sends the specially adapted response letter attached in Annex 3.3.	

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
Essex Plus cases: GBS PTC Officer provides response letter to Phoenix Labs with a summary of the investigation report via email (see section 4.1.6. Exceptions and special cases).	
4.1.7 RQU Contact list For CH products registration status in the respective country as well as Manufacturing Site are available via SYNAPS: go/synaps. List with the respective RQU contact names are provided by the Divisional Quality Assurance function and available on the SharePoint: PH: *PH RQU responsible list_HJ.xlsx* CH: *IQMS_MASTER LIST COMPLAINT RESPONSIBILITIES.xlsx*	GBS
4.1.8 List of Local Opportunities Products *n/a*	
4.1.9 Data Privacy Requirements Finland and Poland follow the rules of the same GDPR act, hence there is no restrictions in personal data flow. Every e-mail should contain data privacy statement. In case of complaint cases received from pharmacies, only the name of the pharmacy is populated. The contact details of a particular pharmacy that raised the case, are stored in Tuovi system.	
4.1.10 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation) In case when the CQU receives a complaint first by a phone, then Product Complaint Form (see Annex 1) is used to document received information. The CQU sends this form to the GBS via e-mail as soon as possible, because the timeline starts when phone complaint is received by the CQU. Translation is obtained from Bayer Service Translation Office via translation tool, as for all macro languages in the scope. In case of answering the client, as Finnish is not hosted by GBS, PTC officers use the standard response letters/texts provided by the CQH in Finland. For gathering additional information directly from the consumer (e.g. batch number, photos, more complaint details, details of the pharmacy with the returned sample) GBS Officer uses a letter provided in Annex 2.2. In cases when the use of Finnish communication templates provided in Annexes are not sufficient to receive necessary information from the consumer, client or other reporter, GBS Team uses Bayer AI machine translator to provide the required message in Finnish. The message is sent with both translated Finnish and original English text using a template with the statement attached, provided in Annex 4.	GBS CQU

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

Essex Plus cases:

Phoenix Labs is responsible for gathering additional information (see section 4.1.6. Exceptions and special cases).

4.1.11 Reimbursement and Replacement

GBS

The reimbursement process starts at the complainant's request and if the sample is declared to be available. Complainant receives replacement product only via the pharmacy. The pharmacy can be credited new package for free by Tamro wholesaler that provided the product to the pharmacy.
GBS PTC Officer opens the "Insert info" section in Tuovi and fills in text from template (see Annex 2.1) under “Info for Customer” and marks ‘compensate with product’ under “Tamro Instructions”. The reimbursement process is managed by Tuovi system that is connected to Tamro wholesaler.

In case of complaints received not via Tuovi system PTC Officer sends the standard template via email to inform about the possibility of reimbursement (see Annex 2.2).

The reimbursement is granted in case of unsuccessful IUS product insertion only if sample is returned for investigation.

In case of expensive PH products listed below, the compensation is upon a decision of Country Manager Finland who needs to be contacted by GBS PTC officer by email. The confirmation of reimbursement is populated by GBS PTC officer in Tuovi system once acknowledged by Country Manager Finland. The message: ‘Hyvitetään uudella pakkauksella’ (Reimbursed with new packaging) is entered in Info tab in Tuovi system with sample sending instruction as for all other products.

Contact information:
For Nexavar, Stivarga, Vitrakvi, Nubeqa, Eylea, Kovaltry and Jivi – Mikko Heikkinen, email address: *mikko.heikkinen@bayer.com*

4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translations

GBS

For all countries where the complaints are sent out for translation to the translation tool, once a year mandatory spot checks must be performed. 5% of all complaint numbers per year should be checked by native speaker (based on random selection), e.g. CQU. Important is to check the “original income text” with “translated text” provided by translation provider.

The GBS is the owner of the process and starts this action. The GBS leads the process, picks the cases and provides report to the CQU. The CQU checks the translation and indicates the deviations.

Acceptance Criteria:

- No Major translation deviations
- Total number of Minor translation deviations is less than 5%.

. Deviations in the translation can be described as Minor or Major.

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

- Minor translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section of a sentence has been insufficiently translated, but the essence or meaning of the original message is still captured.
- Major translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section has been incorrectly translated (for example by the introduction of a new word or exclusion of a word from the original complaint in the translated version) which results in an incorrect essence or meaning in the translation of the original message.

In case of a major translation deviation and exceeding 5% minor cases, the GBS will be informed promptly to open a deviation in the complaint database and to ensure appropriate CAPAs.

In addition, the translation office needs to be informed.

4.1.13 Exceptions and special cases

Receiving complaints in Tuovi system:
Finnish complaints are received mainly via the Tuovi system which associates all the pharmacies in Finland. Notification about new incoming complaints is received at the generic email address *ptc.fi@bayer.com*. A description of how to obtain the complaints in Tuovi and how to use this system can be found below in section 4.1.14 Others.

Complaints reported via social media:
Complaints reported via social media are received by local PV and then forwarded to GBS PTC officers. These can be sent as:
PTC form
Bayer PV form, if applicable
Screenshot from social media

Communication with Medical Information:
Medical Information (MedInfo) contacts GBS to inform about PTC or PTC+AE cases. The generic email for MedInfo: *medinfo@bayer.fi*

Contacting the hospitals, in the case of Xofigo:
Hospitals in Finland can be contacted only by customer service or sales representatives of Bayer, GBS is not allowed to contact hospitals directly. Communication is managed by customer service or sales representatives who need to inform GBS PTC officers about the steps that are taken.

AE number handling when entering Essure cases:
Received PTC+AE case for Essure needs to be entered in complaint database system with notification TBA (to be announced) in the field for AE number.
Complaint ID needs to be sent to Riikka Aarnio, Business Support Specialist (email address *riikka.aarnio@bayer.com*), regardless of if this case was received from her or from a hospital.
When the CIOMS form with the actual AE number comes, it needs to be attached in the communication protocol with a request to RQU to change the AE number in the field.

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
Complaints concerning Essex Plus: Essex Plus is no longer owned by Bayer. The current owner is Phoenix Labs. Complaint details received by Phoenix Labs: Phoenix Lab registers the complaint in their own complaint database and shares complaint details with GBS. GBS PTC Officer registers the complaint in the complaint database and sends the PTC ID to Phoenix Lab. Complaint details received by GBS PTC team: GBS Officer forwards all complaint details to Phoenix Lab and sends the PTC ID after entering the case in the complaint database system. Phoenix Lab is responsible for obtaining all missing information from the complainant and for performing sample retrieval and shipment to RQU. Phoenix Lab provides case number which PTC GBS Officer adds in the Comments field in the complaint database system. Once the investigation is completed GBS PTC Officer provides a response letter to Phoenix Labs with a summary of the investigation report via email. Contact email address to Phoenix Labs: medicalinformation@phoenixlabs.ie	
4.1.14 Others TUOVI working instruction: Respective GBS PTC officers are granted access to Tuovi system. This system can be entered by clicking on this link: *https://tamroapps.tamro.fi/spd/login_frontpage.jsf* and filling in the Username and Password fields in the right upper corner. Once the GBS PTC officers are logged in, it is recommended to switch into English language in the main tab on the left by clicking on the English flag. New complaints can be found when clicking on ‘Quality complaint” -> “>Search” button located on the left. When searching for the newest complaints, Start Date in Quality Complaint Search can be chosen to today's date. To open a complaint, click on complaint ID. Each Tuovi complaint is given a unique ID and contains: Customer data Customer name Customer internal number Contact person for a respective complaint Phone Email Product Data: Product internal number Product Name Supplier's Product Number GTIN Batch Expiry Date Quality Complaint Data: Created Target Amount of defective packages Already Compensated: Yes or No Counterpart needed	

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
Compensation Description Defect detected Returned to Tamro/Supplier Description Attachment Order Date Order number Own Reference Own Reference 2 Own Reference 3 ADR Status Internal comment Returned to Tamro date Returned amount Returned to Supplier Compensated by Tamro date Compensated amount Compensated by Supplier Info (where the acknowledgment letter is populated): Package handling information to a Customer Instructions for Tamro (shipment address should be populated here) Compensation info for Tamro: Compensate with product Package handling information for Tamro The complaints appear in Tuovi system in a periodic order. New complaints are marked as ‘New’ in the status tab. Once the PTC officer acknowledges a complaint, the status is changed to “Open”. At this stage the complainant should be informed about granting the replacement of a complained product and plan of action regarding the sample shipment. To do that, the GBS PTC officer can click on “Insert info” and fill in text under “Info for Customer” and “Instruction for Tamro” fields that should be populated with an acknowledgment letter in Finnish at this stage. To enter this information into the system, PTC officer clicks on “Save”. The status of a complaint is changed to “Handled” by GBS PTC officers when the respective investigation site confirms the successful sample delivery.	

5 Internal References

- SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaints and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”

6 External References

- N/A

History of changes

Version	Significant changes with respect to previous version	Effective date
1	New document	2020-07-13
2	# Chapter 3.3 Change in sample handling scope of CQU/CQH # Chapter 4.1.2 CQH deputy contact updated # Chapter 4.1.5 Sample handling process workflow updated # Chapter 4.1.5 Essure samples handling details updated # Chapter 4.1.6 Template in country specific languages are added as a protected annex to the Country Specific SOP, Annexes numeration updated # Chapter 4.1.10 New template for direct information gathering from the consumer added # Chapter 4.1.10 Described how to use Annex 1 for CQU to forward the complaint received by phone # Chapter 4.1.11 Business Unit Heads contacts updated # New chapter 4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translation # Chapter 4.1.13 Information about phone received complaints deleted # Chapter 4.1.13 Repeated information about Medinfo contact deleted # Chapter 4.1.14 A link to Tuovi Tamro system updated	2021-06-28
3	# All document: Change from SSC or SSCDN to GBS wherever GBS actions or references to other documents are mentioned. # Chapter 4.1.1 Change of Headquarters address # Chapter 4.1.4 Change of PV e-mail address # Chapter 4.1.5 Added the paragraph about radiology samples # Chapter 4.1.5 Change of e-mail address, name and the name of the role of Business Support Specialist # Chapter 4.1.10 Added the paragraph about usage of Annex 5 # Chapter 4.1.11 Change of name and e-mail address of person responsible for Eylea, Kovaltry and Jivi reimbursements # Chapter 4.1.13 Change the Women's Health Assistant to Business Support Specialist # Chapter 8 Added of Annex 5 # Annex 2.1 New template # Annex 3.2 New Template	2023-11-17
4	# Updated according to SSC-PTC-BP-002 "Country specific SOP template" version 5.0 # Chapter 4.1.5 Sample handling process workflow updated, added the paragraph concerning Phoenix Labs cases # Chapter 4.1.6 Statement letter updated, added the paragraph concerning Phoenix Labs cases, added the Remark regarding Annex 3.3 # Chapter 4.1.10 Annexes numeration updated, added the paragraph concerning Phoenix Labs cases # Chapter 4.1.11 Reimbursement and Replacement updated # Chapter 4.1.13 Exceptions and special cases updated, Complaints reported via social media description updated, Communication with Medical Information updated, added paragraph of complaints concerning Essex Plus # Annex 2.1 Updated # Annex 2.2 Updated # Annex 3.3 Added # Annex 4 Updated	2024-07-26

5	# Updated according to SSC-PTC-BP-002 v.6.0 Country Specific SOP template # Roles and responsibilities updated based on SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0 # Complaint database system name updated from “Dev@com” to “complaint database” due to change of the complaint database system # Chapter 4.1.3 Escalation rules: escalation on initial risk category removed, escalation regarding final risk categories changed to high and medium according to SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0 # Chapter 4.1.5 Contact to Business Support Specialist updated # Chapter 4.1.6 Statement letter section updated # Chapter 4.1.13 Contact to Business Support Specialist updated # Chapter 8 Templates Data Privacy statement updated in all Annexes	2025-09-05
6	As part of CAPA-2025-019360, document will upload new version to add the templates for Annex chapter for the SOP that was missed out on the current effective version 5.0.	See cover page

7 Annex 1

Product Complaint Form

Complaint created (date)……
Complaint received (date) ……

Product information:	
Product name	
Batch / lot number	
Dosage form *(cream, tablet, capsule, etc.)*	
Package type/size	
Number of packages	
Sample available?*	Yes/No
*Sample available = please keep for further potential shipment	

Complaint information:	
Complaint description (defect description, is it suspected counterfeit case, etc.)	
Adverse event reported?	Yes/No
Does the complainant expect a response from Bayer?**	
**By requesting a response, the Complainant agrees to his/hers contact data being processed by Bayer for the purpose of providing the answer to the submitted complaint *(the exact sounding to be aligned with legal)*	

Complainants' contact information attention: in the countries with special Data Privacy regulations to be replaced by the complainant code number (to be given by CQU)	
Name and surname	
E-mail address	
Telephone	
Home address	

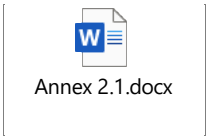
Sender (if other than Complainant, e.g. a pharmacy)	
Senders' Name (Legal entity)	
Address	
E-Mail address	
Telephone number	

Any additional information	

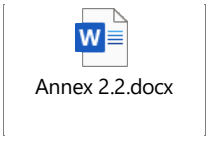
8 Templates

Annex 2

2.1. Reimbursement information in Tuovi chat.



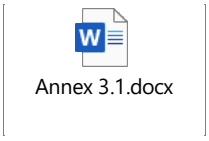
2.2. A letter to the consumer requesting more information/batch number/pictures/sample and informing the consumer about a possibility of the exchange at the pharmacy.



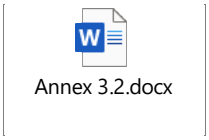
Annex 3

Standard response letters:

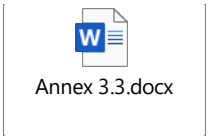
***3.1.* Unconfirmed quality defect**



***3.2.* Confirmed quality defect**

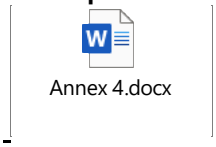


***3.3.* Response letter concerning complaint about handling issue of Bepanthen EDROS bottle.**



Annex 4

4. Template to be used while using Bayer AI translation.



Task: Content Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Approval to be made Effective	Zaneta Gorska-Bilas (ZANETA.GORSKA-BILAS@BAYER.COM) Approver - Content 21-Oct-2025 09:19:26 GMT+0000
Task: Final Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Final Approval to be made Effective	Katariina Alanne (katariina.alanne@bayer.com) Approver - QA 21-Oct-2025 09:38:07 GMT+0000
Task: Final Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Final Approval to be made Effective	katarzyna mazur kominek (katarzyna.mazur-kominek@bayer.com) Approver 28-Oct-2025 10:05:41 GMT+0000